INCH-POUND

MIL-DTL-28839B
20 May 2013
SUPERSEDING
MIL-DTL-28839A
22 July 2003

DETAIL SPECIFICATION

WAVEGUIDES, ELLIPTICAL
GENERAL SPECIFICATION FOR

THIS SPECIFICATION IS INACTIVE FOR
NEW DESIGN AFTER 8 MAY 1998

This specification is approved for use by all Departments
and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for flexible and semi-rigid waveguides with elliptical inside configuration (see 6.1).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 General. The documents listed in this section are specified in sections 3 and 4 of this specification. This section does not include documents cited in other sections of this specification or recommended for additional information or as examples. While every effort has been made to ensure the completeness of this list, document users are cautioned that they must meet all specified requirements of documents cited in sections 3 and 4 of this specification, whether or not they are listed.

2.2 Government documents.

2.2.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those, cited in the solicitation or contract (see 6.2).

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE SPECIFICATIONS

MIL-DTL-5541	-	Chemical Conversion Coatings on Aluminum and Aluminum Alloys.
MIL-DTL-28839/1	-	Waveguides, Elliptical, Semi-rigid.

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE STANDARDS

MIL-STD-129	-	Military Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-202	-	Electronic and Electrical Component Parts.
MIL-STD-1285	-	Marking of Electrical and Electronic Parts.

Comments, suggestions or questions on this document should be addressed to DLA Land and Maritime, ATTN: VAT, Post Office Box 3990, Columbus, OH 43218-3990, or emailed to Tubesamps@dla.mil. Since contact information can change, you may want to verify the currency of this address information using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

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2.3 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM) INTERNATIONAL

ASTM-B241/B241M - Aluminum and Aluminum-Alloy, Seamless Pipe and Seamless Extruded Tube .

ASTM-B152/B152M - Copper Sheet, Strip, Plate, and Rolled Bar.

(Copies are available online at http://www.astm.org or at ASTM International, P.O. Box C700, 100 Barr Harbor Drive, West Conshohocken, PA 19428-2959)

2.4 Order of precedence. Unless otherwise noted herein or in the contract, in the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein (except for related specification sheets), the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Specification sheets. The individual item requirements shall be as specified herein and in accordance with the applicable specification sheet. In the event of any conflict between the requirements of this specification and the specification sheet, the latter shall govern.

3.2 First article. When specified (see 6.2), the contractor shall furnish a sample unit for first article inspection and approval (see 4.4 and 6.3).

3.3 Materials. The material shall be as specified (see 3.1). Acceptance or approval of any constituent material shall not be construed as a guaranty of the finished product.

3.3.1 Aluminum alloy. Aluminum alloys 1060, 1100, 6061, and 6063 shall conform to the chemical composition limits of ASTM-B241/B241M. The minimum resistivity shall be as follows:

a. 1060, 28 micro ohms/centimeter.

b. 1100, 2.90 micro ohms/centimeter.

c. 6061, 4.0 micro ohms/centimeter.

d. 6063, 3.4 micro ohms/centimeter.

3.3.2 Copper. Copper type OF shall conform to ASTM-B152/B152M.

3.3.3 Jacket. Waveguide jacket material shall meet or exceed all requirements of this specification (see 6.6).

3.3.4 Pure tin. The use of pure tin as an underplate or final finish is prohibited both internally and externally. Tin content of the waveguide components and solder shall not exceed 97 percent, by mass. Tin shall be alloyed with a minimum of 3 percent lead, by mass (see 6.7).

3.4 Design and construction. Waveguides shall be of the design, construction, and physical dimensions specified (see 3.1).

3.4.1 Finish. The interior and exterior (except for jacketed waveguides) surfaces of the waveguide shall be bright, smooth, dry, and free of scales or oxide. All aluminum alloy waveguides shall be chemically treated in accordance with MIL-DTL-5541.

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3.4.2 Length. The length of the finished waveguide shall be as specified (see 3.1). The waveguide length tolerance shall be in accordance with table I.

TABLE I. Length tolerances.

Waveguide length	Tolerance
(feet)	
0-25	-0 +1 inch
25 or greater	± 2 percent

3.5 Voltage standing wave ratio (VSWR). When waveguides are tested as specified in 4.6.2, the VSWR shall not exceed the value specified (see 3.1).

3.6 Attenuation. When waveguides are tested as specified in 4.6.3, the attenuation shall not exceed the value specified (see 3.1).

3.7 Pressurization (flexible type only). When waveguides are tested as specified in 4.6.4, there shall be no leakage, no distortion of aperture due to pressure, and the pressure shall not have dropped more than 2 lb_f/ft^2. After the test, the VSWR shall be as specified in 3.5.

3.8 Bending radius (flexible type only). When waveguides are tested as specified in 4.6.5, the bend shall be smooth and continuous without distortion of the cross-sectional aperture. After this test, the VSWR shall be as specified in 3.5.

3.9 Axial twist. When waveguides are tested as specified in 4.6.6, the twist shall be smooth and continuous without distortion of the cross-sectional aperture. After this test, the VSWR shall be as specified in 3.5.

3.10 Vibration, high frequency (flexible type only). When waveguides are tested as specified in 4.6.7, there shall be no mechanical damage to the jacket or the metal structure, as applicable. After this test, the VSWR and attenuation shall be as specified in 3.5 and 3.6, respectively.

3.11 Shock (specified pulse), (flexible type only). When waveguides are tested as specified in 4.6.8, there shall be no evidence of cracking or separation of the jacket, as applicable. After this test, the VSWR and attenuation shall be as specified in 3.5 and 3.6, respectively.

3.12 Moisture resistance (flexible type only). When waveguides are tested as specified in 4.6.9, there shall be no evidence of cracking or separation of the jacket, as applicable. After this test, the VSWR and attenuation shall be as specified in 3.5. and 3.6, respectively.

3.13 Thermal shock (flexible type only). When waveguides are tested as specified in 4.6.10, there shall be no evidence of damage to the jacket or metal structure. After this test, the VSWR and attenuation shall be as specified, in 3.5 and 3.6, respectively.

3.14 Power handling capability (when specified, see 3.1 and 6.2). When waveguides are tested as specified in 4.6.11, there shall be no evidence of mechanical damage to the metal structure or the jacket, as applicable. After this test, the VSWR shall be as specified in 3.5.

3.15 Surface roughness. When waveguides are tested as specified in 4.6.12, the interior surface roughness shall not exceed the value specified (see 3.1).

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3.16 Marking. The waveguide shall be marked in accordance with method I of MIL-STD-1285, with the PIN and the manufacturer's source code. The manufacturer's name or trademark may also be marked on the waveguide, provided such letters are not expressly forbidden in the contract. The marking shall be applied with a permanent ink or paint along one side of the waveguide. Not more than 12-inch intervals shall be permitted from the end of one marking to the beginning of the next marking.

3.17 Recycled, recovered, or environmentally preferable materials. Recycled, recovered, or environmentally preferable materials should be used to the maximum extent possible provided that the material meets or exceeds the operational and maintenance requirements, and promotes economically advantageous life cycle costs.

3.18 Workmanship. The waveguide shall be free from defects of a nature that may interfere with normal military applications. The waveguide shall be uniform in composition, free from internal and external mechanical imperfections, and shall have a clean, bright appearance in accordance with good commercial practice. The interior surface of the waveguide shall be free from burrs, die marks, dirt, grease, scales, and splinters.

4. VERIFICATION

4.1 Classification of inspections. The inspections specified herein are classified as follows:

a. Materials inspection (see 4.3).

b. First article inspection (see 4.4).

c. Conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.2 Inspection conditions. Unless otherwise specified herein, all inspections shall be performed in accordance with the test conditions specified in the "GENERAL REQUIREMENTS" of MIL-STD-202.

4.3 Materials inspection. Materials inspection shall consist of certification supported by verifying data that the materials listed in table II, used in fabricating the waveguide, are in accordance with the applicable referenced specifications or requirements prior to such fabrication.

TABLE II. Materials inspection.

Material	Requirement paragraph	Applicable specification
Aluminum alloy	3.3.1	ASTM-B241/B241M
Copper	3.3.2	ASTM-B152/B152M
Jacket	3.3.3	(see 6.6)

4.4 First article inspection. First article inspection shall be performed by the contractor, after award of contract and prior to production, at a location acceptable to the Government. First article inspection shall be performed on a sample unit which has been produced with equipment and procedures normally used in production. Unless extended by the Government to other contracts, first article approval is valid only on the contract under which it is granted.

4.4.1 Sample size. One waveguide shall be subjected to first article inspection.

4.4.2 Inspection routine. The sample shall be subjected to the inspections specified in table III, in the order shown.

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TABLE III. First article inspection.

Inspection	Requirement paragraph	Test method paragraph
Visual and mechanical inspection	3.3 thru 3.4.2, 3.16, and 3.17	4.6.1
VSWR	3.5	4.6.2
Attenuation	3.6	4.6.3
Pressurization 1/	3.7	4.6.4
Bending radius	3.8	4.6.5
Axial twist	3.9	4.6.6
Vibration, high frequency 1/	3.10	4.6.7
Shock (specified pulse) 1/	3.11	4.6.8
Moisture resistance 1/	3.12	4.6.9
Thermal shock 1/	3.13	4.6.10
Power handling capability 2/	3.14	4.6.11
Surface roughness	3.15	4.6.12

1/ Flexible type only.
2/ When specified (see 3.1 and 6.2).

4.4.3 Failures. One failure shall be cause for refusal to grant first article approval.

4.5 Conformance inspection.

4.5.1 Inspection of product for delivery. An inspection of product for delivery shall consist of groups A and B inspection.

4.5.1.1 Inspection lot. An inspection lot shall consist of all the waveguides of the same PIN, produced under essentially the same conditions, and offered for inspection at one time.

4.5.1.2 Group A inspection. Group A inspection shall consist of the inspections specified in table IV, in the order shown.

TABLE IV. Group A inspection.

Inspection	Requirement paragraph	Test method paragraph
Visual and mechanical inspection	3.3 thru 3.4.2, 3.16, and 3.17	4.6.1
VSWR	3.5	4.6.2
Attenuation	3.6	4.6.3
Pressurization 1/	3.7	4.6.4

1/ Flexible type only.

4.5.1.2.1 Group A sampling plan. Statistical sampling and inspection shall be performed on an inspection lot basis with a random sample of waveguides selected in accordance with table V. Acceptance levels shall be based upon the zero defective sampling plan. No failures shall be permitted.

TABLE V. Group A sampling plan.

Lot size	Sample size
1-13	100 percent
14-150	13
151-280	20
281-500	29
501-1,200	34
1,201-3,200	42
3,201-10,000	50

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4.5.1.2.2 Rejected lots. If an inspection lot is rejected, the contractor may rework it to correct the defects, or screen out the defective units, and resubmit for re-inspection. Resubmitted lots shall be inspected using tightened inspection. Such lots shall be separate from new lots, and shall be clearly identified as re-inspected lots.

4.5.1.3 Group B inspection. Group B inspection shall consist of the inspections specified in table VI, in the order shown. The sample for group B inspection shall be selected from inspection lots that have passed the group A inspection.

TABLE VI. Group B inspection.

Inspection	Requirement paragraph	Test method paragraph
Bending radius	3.8	4.6.5
Axial twist	3.9	4.6.6
Vibration 1/	3.10	4.6.7
Shock (specified pulse) 1/	3.11	4.6.8
Moisture resistance 1/	3.12	4.6.9
Thermal shock 1/	3.13	4.6.10
Power handling capability 2/	3.14	4.6.11

1/ Flexible type only.
2/ When specified (see 3.1 and 6.2).

4.5.1.3.1 Group B sampling plan. One length of the production lot shall be tested. If the size of the production lot is greater than 25 pieces, one additional length shall be tested per each 25 additional pieces in the lot.

4.5.1.3.2 Failures. If one or more sample units fail to pass group B inspection, the lot shall be considered to have failed.

4.5.1.3.3 Disposition of sample units. Sample units which have been subjected to group B inspection shall not be delivered on the contract.

4.6 Methods of inspection.

4.6.1 Visual and mechanical inspection. Waveguides shall be examined to verify that the materials, design, construction, physical dimensions, finish, length, marking and workmanship are in accordance with the applicable requirements (see 3.3 thru 3.4.2, 3.16 and 3.17).

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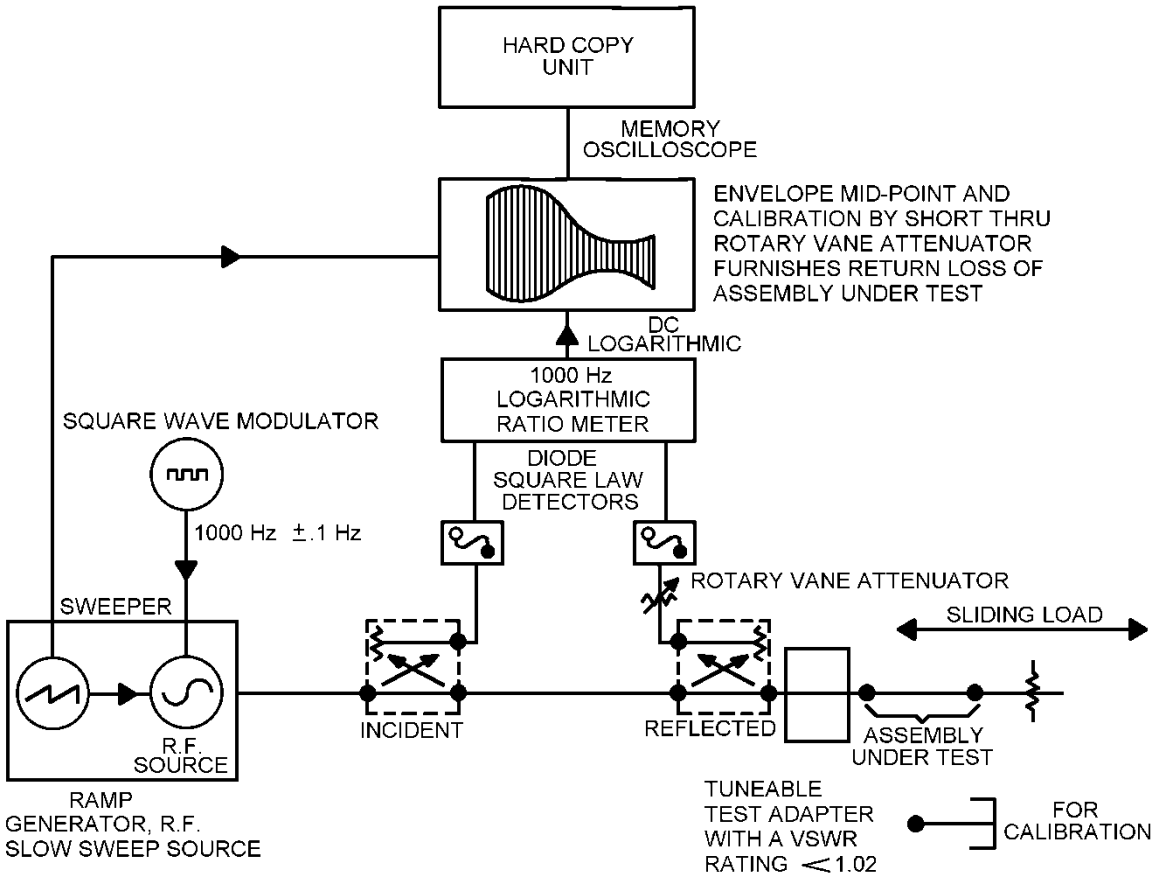


FIGURE 1. VSWR test setup (or equivalent).

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4.6.2 Voltage standing wave ratio (VSWR, see 3.5). The VSWR of the waveguide shall be measured over the specified frequency range (see 3.1), using the test set up of figure 1. The test equipment shall be capable of providing a continuous measurement of VSWR over the required frequency range. A means shall be provided for producing a permanent record of the waveguides' VSWR versus frequency. The permanent record shall indicate the worst case VSWR numerically and shall provide the calculation used to obtain the calculated VSWR. The measurement system and permanent record shall provide a minimum accuracy of .03 in VSWR. Other test methods of equal accuracy may be used.

4.6.3 Attenuation (see 3.6). The attenuation of the waveguide shall be measured over the specified frequency range (see 3.1), using the test set-up of figure 2. The test equipment shall be capable of providing a continuous measurement of attenuation over the required frequency range. A means shall be provided to produce a permanent record of the waveguide's attenuation versus frequency. The measurement system and permanent record shall provide a minimum accuracy of .01 dB for the frequency range of 2.60 thru 26.5 GHZ and .02 dB for frequency ranges of .32 through 2.60 GHZ and 26.5 through 90 GHZ. The zero trace is formed by a measurement of the adapters back-to-back (the normalizer could then subtract this attenuation. Other test methods of equal accuracy may be used.

4.6.4 Pressurization (see 3.7). The waveguide shall be subjected to the internal air pressure in pound-force per square foot (lb_f/ft^2) specified (see 3.1). The pressurization supply shall be disconnected and pressure maintained in the waveguide for 4 hours. At the end of the 4-hour period, the waveguide pressure shall not have dropped more than 2 lb_f/ft^2. The VSWR shall be measured while under pressure as specified in 4.6.2.

4.6.5 Bending radius (see 3.8). One end of the waveguide shall be fixed to a stationary platform with the waveguide supported in a horizontal position. The free end of the waveguide shall then be bent around a circular mandrel with the specified radius (see 3.1), to at least a 180-degree bend. A representative sample of the same PIN as the waveguide under test may be used for this test. The length of the representative sample shall be sufficient to complete the 180-degree bend. After completion of the bend, the VSWR shall be measured as specified in 4.6.2.

4.6.6 Arial twist (see 3.9). One end of the waveguide shall be fastened to a stationary platform with the waveguide supported in a horizontal position. To prevent the waveguide from bending, a rigid shaft shall be extended through the waveguide and fastened to the stationary platform. The free end of the waveguide shall be twisted through a 90-degree angle. The length of the twisted section shall be as specified (see 3.1). A representative sample of the same PIN as the waveguide under test may be used for the axial twist test. The length of the representative sample shall be sufficient to complete the 90-degree twist. After completion of the twist, the VSWR shall be measured as specified in 4.6.2.

4.6.7 Vibration, high frequency (see 3.10). Waveguides shall be tested in accordance with method 204, MIL-STD-202. The following details shall apply:

a. Mounting: Unless otherwise specified (see 3.1), rigidly mounted to an appropriate non-resonant mounting table.

b. Electrical load: Not applicable.

c. Test condition letter: A.

d. Resonance: Not applicable.

e. Measurements after vibration: VSWR and attenuation shall be measured as specified in 4.6.2 and 4.6.3, respectively.

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4.6.8 Shock (specified pulse (see 3.11). Waveguides shall be tested in accordance with method 213, MIL-STD-202.

a. Mounting: Unless otherwise specified (see 3.1), rigidly mounted to test platform.

b. Test condition letter: G.

c. Measurements after shock: VSWR and attenuation shall be measured as specified in 4.6.2 and 4.6.3, respectively.

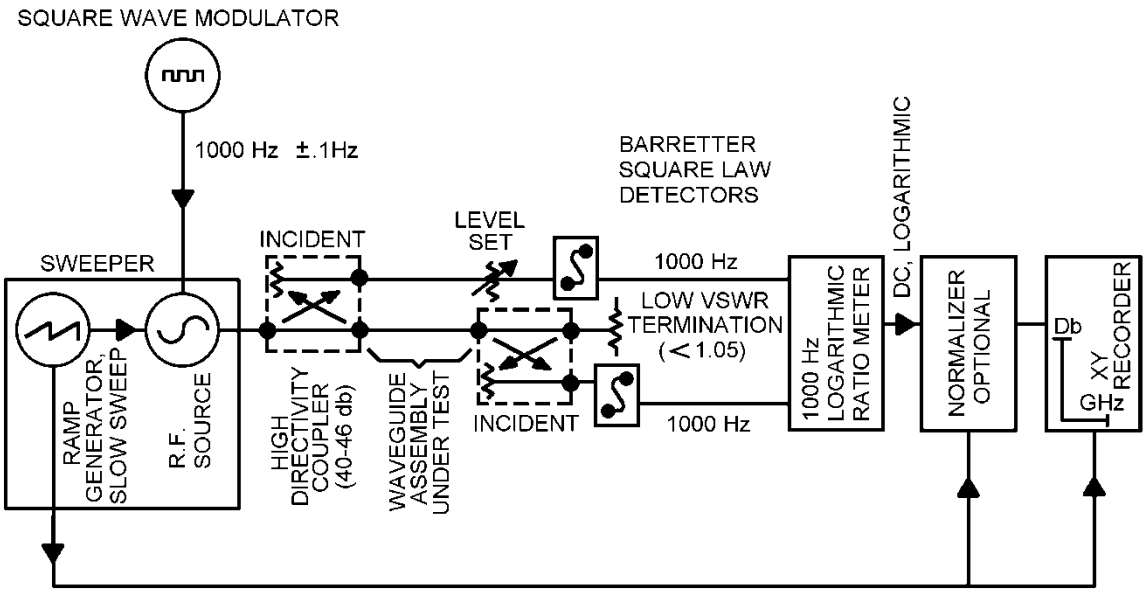


FIGURE 2. Attenuation test setup (or equivalent).

4.6.9 Moisture resistance (see 3.12). Waveguides shall be tested in accordance with method 106, MIL-STD-202. The following details shall apply:

a. Initial measurements: Not applicable.

b. Polarization voltage: Not applicable.

c. Loading voltage: Not applicable.

d. Measurements after test: VSWR and attenuation shall be measured as specified in 4.6.2 and 4.6.3, respectively.

4.6.10 Thermal shock (see 3.13). Waveguides shall be tested in accordance with method 107, MIL-STD-202. The following details shall apply:

a. Special mounting: Not applicable.

b. Test condition letter: A.

c. Measurements before test: Not applicable.

d. Measurements after test: VSWR and attenuation shall be measured as specified in 4.6.2 and 4.6.3, respectively.

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4.6.11 Power handling capability (when specified, see 3.1 and 6.2) (see 3.14). The waveguide shall be subjected to the radio frequency power level specified (see 3.1) at the frequency, simulated altitude, and temperature specified (see 3.1). Power shall be maintained for 1 hour after the temperature of the waveguide has reached equilibrium (temperature shall not vary more than 5°C within a 15-minute period). During the test, the waveguide shall be terminated in a matched load (1.05 VSWR, maximum). After the test, VSWR shall be measured as specified in 4.6.2.

4.6.12 Surface roughness (see 3.15). The average interior surface roughness of the waveguide shall be measured using a brush type profilometer. A 1-foot length shall be cut in half longitudinally. Then both lateral and longitudinal surface roughness tests shall be made over the entire length of the two halves.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. For acquisition purposes, the packaging requirements shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2). When packaging of materiel is to be performed by DoD or in-house contractor personnel, these personnel need to contact the responsible packaging activity to ascertain requisite packaging requirements. Packaging requirements are maintained by the Inventory Control Point's packaging activities within the Military Service or Defense Agency, or within the military service's system commands. Packaging data retrieval is available from the managing Military Department's or Defense Agency's automated packaging files, CD-ROM products, or by contacting the responsible packaging activity.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. Waveguides covered by this specification are intended for use as radio frequency transmission lines in military services electronic equipment.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification. The complete PIN (see 3.1).

b. Packaging requirements (see 5.1).

c. Requirements for power handling capability testing (see 3.1 and 3.14).

d. When a first article is required for inspection and approval (see 3.2, 4.4 and 6.3).

e. If unitized loads are required (and not at the option of the contractor).

6.3 First article. The first article should be a preproduction sample, a first production item or it may be a standard production item from the contractor's current inventory. The first article should consist of one unit. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisitiont instruments, regarding arrangements for examinations, tests, and approval of the first article.

6.4 Environmentally preferable material. Environmentally preferable materials should be used to the maximum extent possible to meet the requirements of this specification. As of the dating of this document, the U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) is focusing efforts on reducing 31 priority chemicals. The list of chemicals and additional information is available on their website at http://www.epa.gov/osw/hazard/wastemin/priority.htm. Included in the list of 31 priority chemicals are cadmium, lead, and mercury. Use of the materials on the list should be minimized or eliminated unless needed to meet the requirements specified herein (see section 3).

6.5 Subject term (keyword) listing.

Axial twist	Pressurization
Attenuation	Power handling
Bending radius	Semirigid
First article	VSWR
Flexible	

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6.6 Waveguide jacket material. Historically it has been proven that jacket material conforming to L-P-390, type III, class H has satisfied the requirements of this specification.

6.7 Tin whisker growth. The use of alloys with tin content greater than 97 percent, by mass, may exhibit tin whisker growth problems after manufacture. Tin whiskers may occur anytime from a day to years after manufacture and can develop under typical operating conditions, on products that use such materials. Conformal coatings applied over top of a whisker-prone surface will not prevent the formation of tin whiskers. Alloys of 3 percent lead, by mass, have shown to inhibit the growth of tin whiskers (see 3.3.4). For additional information on this matter, refer to ASTM-B545 (Standard Specification for Electrodeposited Coatings of Tin).

6.8 Revision notations. The margins of this specification are marked with vertical lines to indicate modifications generated by this revision. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations.

Custodian:
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Preparing activity:
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Review activities:
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